

MUGHLAI ORIGIN — DELHI, LUCKNOW & HYDERABAD

Rumali Roti

Paper-Thin Handkerchief Bread
The Showpiece of Mughlai Kebab Houses

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

LICENSE & COPYRIGHT NOTICE

Rumali Roti

Sold via: Gumroad
Publisher: DhanioDigital (dhaniodigital.gumroad.com)

PERSONAL USE LICENSE

This digital cookbook is licensed for personal, non-commercial use only.
You may print one (1) copy for your own kitchen use.

YOU MAY NOT:

- Share, resell, or redistribute this file in any form
- Upload to any website, cloud service, or file-sharing platform
- Remove or obscure any watermarks, copyright notices, or branding
- Use recipes for commercial food service without written permission

Violation of this license may result in legal action.

© 2024 DhanioDigital. All rights reserved.
Contact: support@dhaniodigital.com

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Rumali Roti

AUTHOR

Sweta Verma

PUBLISHER

DhanioDigital

COPYRIGHT

© 2026 Sweta Verma. All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced or distributed without written permission from the publisher.

DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Bread as Thin as Silk

Rumali roti takes its name from the Hindi word "rumal," meaning handkerchief — a fitting description for a bread stretched so thin and so soft that it can be folded like fabric. It belongs to the grand tradition of Mughlai cuisine, closely associated with the kebab houses of Delhi, Lucknow, and Hyderabad, where it has long served as the perfect wrapper for skewered, spiced meats fresh off the grill.

Making rumali roti is considered one of the more demanding skills in Indian bread-making. Traditionally, the dough is stretched by hand until nearly transparent, then cooked for mere seconds on the reverse, dome-shaped side of a large iron griddle held over an open flame — a method that requires both practice and a bit of showmanship, which is part of why it's often prepared tableside at Mughlai restaurants as much for the performance as the bread itself.

This recipe adapts the technique for a home kitchen, using a large inverted wok or flat pan in place of the traditional dome griddle. It takes a little patience to get right, but the result — an impossibly soft, delicate bread — is well worth the practice.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Bread as Thin as Silk, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

A signature bread of Mughlai kebab houses in Delhi, Lucknow, and Hyderabad, traditionally used to wrap grilled meats and kebabs. Considered a skill dish, often prepared and stretched tableside as a small performance at traditional restaurants. Valued for its delicate, almost translucent texture, a deliberate contrast to heartier breads like naan and paratha. A dish that showcases a cook's skill more than almost any other Indian bread.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

20m	45m	20m	4
ACTIVE PREP	DOUGH REST	COOK TIME	SERVINGS (6 ROTIS)

Hard
DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Large mixing bowl
- A large inverted wok, kadai, or dome-shaped griddle (traditional method)
- Alternatively, the largest flat non-stick pan you own
- Rolling pin
- A clean, lightly floured, large work surface for stretching

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Rumali roti is meant to be eaten immediately after cooking, while still warm and pliable — it firms up and loses its signature softness within an hour or two. The dough itself can be made up to a day ahead and refrigerated, wrapped well, which actually makes it easier to stretch once rested.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dough

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
All-purpose flour (maida)	1½ cups	190 g	1½ katori
Whole wheat flour (atta)	½ cup	60 g	½ katori
Water, as needed	¾–1 cup	180–240 ml	¾–1 katori
Milk — optional, for extra softness	2 tbsp	30 ml	2 chammach
Salt	½ tsp	3 g	to taste
Oil	1 tbsp	15 ml	1 chammach

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

The blend of all-purpose and whole wheat flour is traditional and gives the best balance of stretch and structure — using only all-purpose flour makes the dough harder to stretch without tearing. This bread requires no special or hard-to-find ingredients, making it accessible anywhere in the world; the challenge lies entirely in technique and practice rather than sourcing.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making and Resting the Dough

01 MIX THE DOUGH

Combine both flours and salt in a large bowl. Add the oil, milk if using, and gradually mix in water, kneading to a very soft, smooth, and elastic dough — noticeably softer than a naan or paratha dough.

02 KNEAD THOROUGHLY

Knead for a full 10–12 minutes. This dough benefits from extended kneading more than almost any other in this collection, since it directly determines how far the dough can stretch without tearing.

Chef tip. the dough should feel almost like soft, elastic putty when properly kneaded — if it resists stretching, it needs more kneading time.

03 REST GENEROUSLY

Cover with a damp cloth and rest for at least 45 minutes, or up to a few hours. This long rest is essential — it's what allows the gluten to relax enough for paper-thin stretching later.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making and Resting the Dough, continued



COOKING CHECKPOINT

Properly rested dough should stretch easily when gently pulled at the edges, without springing back or tearing immediately.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Stretching & Cooking

04 DIVIDE AND PRE-ROLL

Divide the dough into 6 balls. Roll each as thin as you can with a rolling pin on a floured surface, getting it as close to paper-thin as possible before switching to hand-stretching.

05 STRETCH BY HAND

Carefully drape the rolled dough over the backs of your hands (or lay flat and gently pull the edges outward on a floured surface), stretching it further until it's nearly translucent — you should be able to see your hand through it in places.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

Stretching & Cooking, continued



06 COOK BRIEFLY

Heat your inverted wok or largest flat pan until very hot. Drape the stretched dough over the hot surface and cook for just 10–15 seconds per side — this bread cooks almost instantly due to its thinness.

Texture indicator. rumali roti should barely color, staying soft and pale with just a few small light brown speckles — it's meant to be delicate, not crisp.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Stretching & Cooking, continued

07 FOLD AND SERVE

Remove immediately and fold into quarters, like a handkerchief, stacking under a cloth to keep soft and warm while you cook the rest.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Cooking rumali roti for too long is the most common beginner mistake — because it's so thin, it can go from perfectly soft to dry and crisp within seconds. Watch closely and remove the moment it sets.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Folded into quarters and served alongside grilled kebabs, used to wrap bites of meat and chutney.
- A classic pairing with rich Mughlai gravies, where its delicate texture doesn't compete with the sauce.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Restaurant Presentation

- Often folded into a neat triangle or square, stacked in a basket, sometimes prepared tableside as a small show of skill.

Family Style

- Served warm in a stack, letting everyone tear off pieces to wrap their own bites of kebab or curry.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Stretch Right

- Extended kneading and a long dough rest are non-negotiable — rushing either step is the number one reason home cooks struggle with tearing.
- Keep your hands and work surface very lightly floured while stretching — too much flour prevents the dough from stretching evenly.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- The dough actually improves with an overnight rest in the refrigerator, making next-day stretching noticeably easier.
- Practice stretching with a small test piece first if this is your first attempt — it's a skill that improves quickly with just a little repetition.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Professional cooks often work with a partner, one stretching while the other cooks, since the bread cooks in mere seconds and timing matters. At home, prepare all your stretched roti on parchment sheets first, then cook them one after another in quick succession.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

120 kcal	3.5 g	22 g	2 g	1.5 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with fat used and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Sweet Rumali Roti — a rare dessert version lightly dusted with sugar and cardamom, served rolled with rabri (sweetened condensed milk).

Whole Wheat Rumali Roti — a higher proportion of whole wheat flour for a heartier, slightly nuttier version.

Egg Rumali Roti — a modern restaurant variation with a thin layer of beaten egg cooked onto one side.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Do I need a special pan for this?

The traditional inverted dome griddle isn't available in most home kitchens — the largest flat or lightly domed pan you own will work, as long as it can get very hot.

Why does my dough keep tearing when I stretch it?

Usually insufficient kneading or too short a rest. Both build the gluten's elasticity, which is what allows the dough to stretch this thin without tearing.

Is this a beginner-friendly recipe?

It's the most advanced bread in this collection — expect a learning curve, but the technique improves quickly with practice, and even imperfect rumali roti tastes wonderful.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Rumal	Hindi for handkerchief, describing this bread's thin, foldable texture.
Ulta Tawa	an inverted, dome-shaped griddle traditionally used to cook rumali roti.
Maida	refined white flour, blended with whole wheat for this bread's structure.
Mughlai	referring to the cuisine of the Mughal era, known for its refined, restaurant-style dishes.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Rumali Roti

20m ACTIVE PREP	**45m** DOUGH REST
20m COOK TIME	**4** SERVINGS (6 ROTIS)
Hard DIFFICULTY	

DOUGH

All-purpose flour	190 g
Whole wheat flour	60 g
Water	180–240 ml
Milk — optional	30 ml
Salt	3 g
Oil	15 ml

METHOD

01 **Mix the dough.** Combine both flours and salt in a large bowl.

02 **Knead thoroughly.** Knead for a full 10–12 minutes.

03 **Rest generously.** Cover with a damp cloth and rest for at least 45 minutes, or up to a few hours.

04 **Divide and pre-roll.** Divide the dough into 6 balls.

05 **Stretch by hand.** Carefully drape the rolled dough over the backs of your hands (or lay flat and gently pull the edges outward on a floured surface), stretching it further until it's nearly translucent — you should be able to see your hand through it in places.

06 **Cook briefly.** Heat your inverted wok or largest flat pan until very hot.

07 **Fold and serve.** Remove immediately and fold into quarters, like a handkerchief, stacking under a cloth to keep soft and warm while you cook the rest.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

- [ ] All-purpose flour — 190 g
- [ ] Milk — optional — 30 ml
- [ ] Oil — 15 ml
- [ ] Whole wheat flour — 60 g
- [ ] Salt — 3 g

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com